

Azure Blob Storage RBAC Setup Guide

Assign your administrator/developer account the Storage Blob Data Contributor role so you can use Microsoft Entra authentication in the Azure portal.

Target container: bc-corp-policy-documents

Goal: Upload, modify, and delete policy documents using Microsoft Entra ID and Azure RBAC instead of relying on an access key for your portal session.

1. Assign Storage Blob Data Contributor

1. In the Azure portal, open the **Storage account** that contains your policy container.
2. Select **Data storage > Containers**.
3. Open **bc-corp-policy-documents**.
4. Select **Access Control (IAM)** from the left menu.
5. Select **+ Add > Add role assignment**.
6. On the **Role** tab, search for and select **Storage Blob Data Contributor**, then select **Next**.
7. Under **Assign access to**, select **User, group, or service principal**.
8. Select **+ Select members**.
9. Search for the Microsoft Entra account you use to sign in to Azure, select it, and choose **Select**.
10. Select **Review + assign**, then select **Review + assign** again to complete the role assignment.

Why container-level scope is recommended

Assigning this role directly on the policy container follows least privilege. Your account can manage blob data in this container without automatically receiving data access to every container in the storage account.

2. Confirm portal navigation permissions

To browse the storage account through the Azure portal using Microsoft Entra authentication, you may also need the **Reader** role at the storage-account level. You may already inherit Reader, Contributor, or Owner from the resource group or subscription.

1. Return to the **Storage account** overview.
2. Open **Access Control (IAM)**.
3. Choose **View my access** to see whether you already have Reader, Contributor, or Owner.
4. If needed, select **+ Add > Add role assignment**, choose **Reader**, and assign it to the same Microsoft Entra account.

Role	Recommended scope	Purpose
Storage Blob Data Contributor	bc-corp-policy-documents container	Read, upload, modify, and delete policy documents
Reader	Storage account	Navigate and view the storage resource in the Azure portal



3. Switch to Microsoft Entra authentication

1. Allow several minutes for the role assignment to propagate. In some environments, it can take longer.
2. Refresh the Azure portal.
3. Reopen **Storage account > Containers > bc-corp-policy-documents**.
4. Next to **Authentication method: Access key**, select **Switch to Microsoft Entra user account**.
5. Confirm that the page now shows Microsoft Entra user account as the authentication method.
6. Open one of your folders and upload a small test document to confirm read/write access.



4. If Add role assignment is disabled

You do not currently have permission to create Azure role assignments. Managing blobs or the storage account does not automatically grant authority to assign RBAC roles.

Ask your Azure subscription administrator to assign the required roles, or to give you an appropriate role-assignment permission such as:

- Owner
- User Access Administrator
- Role Based Access Control Administrator

The permission must exist at the container, storage-account, resource-group, or subscription scope that covers the target container.



5. Security notes for your policy RAG solution

- **Keep the container private.** Switching to Microsoft Entra authentication does not require public blob access.
- **Use Microsoft Entra ID for people.** Your developer/admin account should use Azure RBAC rather than an account key whenever possible.
- **Use managed identity for services.** Azure AI Search should ideally receive Storage Blob Data Reader access through its managed identity.
- **Temporary exception:** If your Azure AI Search preview tier does not support managed identity, its data-source connection may temporarily require a storage connection string or account key. This is separate from how you sign in through the Azure portal.